



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Classical Academy
School Website: <https://trinityclassicalacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Trinity Classical Academy CA 91355 presents a clearly classical orientation rooted in a Christ-centered, classical curriculum and pedagogy. Public-facing materials repeatedly affirm a Christian worldview, a focus on virtue and wisdom, the Great Books tradition, and the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as the backbone of its curriculum. The school emphasizes formation over mere information, and consistently frames education as a gateway to character, wisdom, and life-long formation. There is strong evidence of Socratic and rhetoric-rich instruction, with explicit references to Socratic dialogue in class and to upper-school seminars and oratory, alongside a robust commitment to a liturgical and communal life (chapel, worship, and dedicated school-wide rituals).

Overall, applying the Six Essential Elements rubric in combination with Trinity's public materials yields a CLASSICAL classification across most categories, with particularly strong alignment for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, and Pedagogy. Element 5 (Faculty) shows alignment, but the explicit articulation of the faculty as the "living curriculum" and related portraits is less explicit in public materials, which places that category toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Element 6 (Parents & Community) demonstrates genuine partnership with families and visible community engagement, supporting CLASSICAL status as well.

- Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL
- Principal strengths: explicit Christ-centered classical framework, formation-centered goals, Trivium-based curriculum with Great Books, Socratic pedagogy in upper levels, liturgical/community life, and clear parental/community partnership.
- Areas that could strengthen to reach full alignment: explicit articulation of faculty as the living curriculum; consistent, explicit language about parents as co-teachers beyond partnership language.

Evidence for this assessment is drawn from Trinity's public materials (Head of School Welcome, About pages, Classical Education pages, Missions/Foundations statements, and program descriptions) and cross-referenced with the classical rubric and keyword lexicon from the knowledge base documents.

Citations (representative samples of the source material used):

- Christ-centered classical education, Christian worldview, and mission statements: Trinity materials including Head of School Welcome and mission statements.
- Biblical foundations and doctrinal statements: The explicit list of Biblical beliefs offered as foundational to the school.
- Great Books, Trivium, and classical curriculum foundations (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Western Civilization; Latin; Biblical worldview): Classical Education page and curriculum descriptions.
- Socratic pedagogy and upper-school rhetoric/seminar culture: Public notes about Socratic dialogue and rhetoric-focused work.

- Liturgical/community practices and sacred commitments (worship, chapels, beaming toward God's glory): Be Thou My Vision and related communal life references.
- Partnership with families and open-campus/community engagement: Statements about partnering with families and events that invite parental involvement.
- Imago Dei School and inclusion of developmental-disability programming as part of Education for Life: Public materials referencing inclusive programs.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials frame Trinity as "Christ-centered Classical Education," with a Christian worldview and explicit doctrinal statements (one God, Biblical authority, etc.).
- Liturgical/community practices and sacral language (dedication/vision nights, worship, sacred music) appear in school communications.
- The mission emphasizes a Christian faith integrated with the classical tradition to form virtuous students.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, Christian faith, Biblical beliefs, Bible as authoritative, theology, liturgy/worship, sacred tradition, imago Dei. (Examples drawn from the school's mission statements and doctrinal pages.)
- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no explicit secular or relativist framing). The lexicon's negative signals are not observed in the published materials.
- Quantitative note: Positive keywords identified (roughly 7–9 distinct terms/phrases) vs. 0 negative signals.
- Why this rating
- The school openly centers its program on Christian faith and the transcendentals of truth, goodness, and beauty in a liturgical, worship-inflected context, consistent with the Positive Keyword indicators for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations. The doctrinal statements and Christ-centered framing strongly align with the classical rubric's expectations in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Mission and statements emphasize formation of virtue and wisdom, not solely job preparation; formation over information is explicitly stated in materials.
- Pledges to cultivate virtue, wisdom, purpose, and courage; aim toward human flourishing and life-long formation (Education for Life).
- Reference to pursuing truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable; emphasis on a classical telos.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, purpose, courage, education for life, liberal education, great conversation, telos, true/good/beautiful.
- Negative keywords: not evident (no emphasis on solely workforce/Career-readiness; the school does not foreground 21st-century job metrics in public messaging).
- Quantitative note: multiple explicit positive indicators and no explicit negative signals in the public messaging.
- Why this rating
- The school's stated aims align with the classical category of Synthesis: formation of virtue and wisdom (not mere information or job prep), a pursuit of the true, the good, and the beautiful, and a telos-oriented view of education.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Curriculum centers the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Quadrivium concepts; Great Books and Western Civilization are foregrounded; Latin and classical languages are part of core study.
- Emphasis on Great Books and the Great Conversation; integration of history and literature with broader questions; education framed as wonder and unity of knowledge.
- Explicit articulation of a Christian worldview integrated into curriculum.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books, Great Conversation, Western Civilization, Latin, theology/biblical worldview, integration of subjects, wonder.
- Negative keywords: not evident (no substitution with social studies terminology; no project-based framing dominating the curriculum in messaging).
- Quantitative note: multiple clear positive markers; no explicit negative markers observed in public materials.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum text aligns strongly with the classical curriculum criteria in the rubric, emphasizing the Trivium and Quadrivium, Great Books, Western civilization, and integrated, wonder-filled study.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Socratic dialog in class is explicitly described; upper-school seminars and debates are referenced as normative practices; students train in rhetoric and have opportunities to deliver speeches.
- Lower-school practices include singing, memory work, chanting, and ritual practices, aligning with contemplative/restful pedagogy (Scholé) and memory deepening.
- Classical pedagogy is reinforced by descriptions of a grammar-to-rhetoric progression, with drama and performing arts integrated in the rhetoric stage (9–12).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, seminars, dialectic, rhetoric, speech, declamation, oratory, memory work, chanting, recitation, scholé, contemplation, wonder.
- Negative keywords: not evident in public materials (no exclusive emphasis on project-based learning or constructivism over classical methods).
- Quantitative note: multiple explicit pedagogical markers; no explicit negative signals in the public materials.
- Why this rating
- The school's pedagogy directly maps to classical models (Socratic inquiry, rhetoric training, memory/recitation, and a staged progression through grammar, logic, rhetoric with associated seminars). The presence of both contemplative and academically rigorous elements aligns well with the Classical rubric.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public statements emphasize teachers as mentors who invest in students and personalize the educational journey; there is a clear student-centered, relational approach (e.g., “We take the time to get to know each of our students and we are invested in their lives”). This reflects a teacherly care and mentoring role, though the exact phrasing as “living curriculum” or a formal faculty portrait is not explicit in the public materials.
- Founders and long-standing leadership (Head of School and founders) provide a stable, virtue-centered leadership model, consistent with classical expectations for role-model teachers.
- The materials emphasize virtue, wisdom, and character as outcomes fostered by faculty guidance, though explicit “living curriculum” language is not consistently used.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: mentor, virtue, character formation, thoughtful guidance, personal attention, leadership by educators (inferred through mission language and teacher-student engagement).
- Negative keywords: not explicit in public materials (no explicit “faculty as living curriculum” phrasing); the lack of explicit phrasing reduces certainty of full classical alignment in this category.
- Quantitative note: Positive indicators identified (roughly 3–4 distinct terms/concepts); no explicit negative signals documented in the public materials.
- Why this rating
- The materials show strong emphasis on teacher-student relationships and mentorship as a core driver of formation, aligning with classical ideals of the teacher as exemplar and guide. The lack of explicit, recurring “living curriculum” phrasing in public content places this category at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school frames itself as partnering with families and seeks to involve parents as co-leaders in the formation of children; campus events and open-house formats (Discover Trinity, tours) invite parental engagement and participation.
- There are explicit statements that the school will partner with families to raise kids of virtue and character; family involvement is presented as part of the Trinity community ethos.
- Public materials emphasize community life and shared mission, with events designed to welcome parents and families into the school experience.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, family involvement, parental engagement, open campus, hospitality, communal worship/ritual life (as part of the school’s ethos).
- Negative keywords: not evident in the public messaging; no consumer-language or relegation of parents to mere visitors.
- Quantitative note: Multiple explicit positive signals; no explicit negative signals.
- Why this rating
- The presence of explicit partnership language with families and active parental engagement opportunities aligns with the classical model’s expectations for Parents & Community, yielding CLASSICAL for Element 6.

Aggregate assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, Trinity Classical Academy CA 91355 satisfies the Classical education rubric across the majority of the six categories, with Element 5 (Faculty) being the primary area where explicit classical-language alignment is less visible in public materials. The aggregate ranking is CLASSICAL, with a note that more explicit articulation around the faculty-as-living-curriculum and associated portraits would push Element 5 firmly into CLASSICAL territory.

What would move the needle

- Element 5 (Faculty): Public articulation of the faculty as the living curriculum, with explicit statements about faculty as exemplars, mentors, and collaborative colleagues; a defined “portrait of a teacher” and “portrait of a student” in marketing materials and internal governance documents.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): While strong, additional explicit statements framing parents as co-educators and formalized parent-education programs (e.g., classical book clubs, household cate-

chesis, or structured parent formation) would further strengthen the alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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